AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION

# The Bastion

## Hardening & Defensive Infrastructure Tools

| 33 | 187,212 | 85% | 27 |
|---|---|---|---|
| FREE TOOLS | COMBINED STARS | ON GITHUB | ACTIVE IN 2026 |

33 tools · ← Back to the main list · Data verified **2026-10-22** (re-verified monthly)

## CURATOR'S NOTES

The mirror image of the Armory: what you install so you never get popped. Kernel-level audit, mandatory-access-control lineages (SELinux, OpenBSD PF), host hardening and firewall tooling — the unglamorous layer that stops real breaches.

## MAINTENANCE SNAPSHOT (2026-10-22)

- Active in the last 30 days: 20 of 28 tracked GitHub repos (71%)
- Quiet classics (no push in 12+ months, still listed): OpenRASP
- Earliest entries: Fail2ban (2011), OpenVPN (2012), ClamAV (2012)

*Part of Awesome Cyber Security Heaven — 496 curated free tools across 14 realms*

## FLAGSHIP PICKS — THE HEAVYWEIGHTS

| TOOL | ★ STARS | CREATED | LAST PUSH | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Fail2ban | 18.8k | 2011 | 2026-10-10 ✅ | Daemon to ban hosts that cause multiple authentication errors |
| Lynis | 16.5k | 2013 | 2026-09-16 | Lynis - Security auditing tool for Linux, macOS, and UNIX-based systems. Assists with compliance testing (HIPA… |
| CrowdSec | 15.2k | 2020 | 2026-10-21 ✅ | Open-source IDS/IPS, WAF and bot detection for Linux, Windows, Docker and Kubernetes, with a crowdsourced bloc… |
| OpenVPN | 14.7k | 2012 | 2026-10-22 ✅ | OpenVPN is an open source VPN daemon |
| OpenSnitch | 14.2k | 2017 | 2026-07-26 | OpenSnitch is a GNU/Linux interactive application firewall inspired by Little Snitch. |
| OpenNHP | 13.9k | 2014 | 2026-10-22 ✅ | A lightweight, cryptography-powered, open-source toolkit built to enforce Zero Trust security for infrastructure, applications, and data in the AI-driven world. |

## FULL INVENTORY — 33 CURATED TOOLS

ranked by GitHub adoption · 2026-10-22 census · non-GitHub entries listed last

| TOOL | ★ STARS | CREATED | LAST PUSH | LICENSE / TIER |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Fail2ban | 18.8k | 2011 | 2026-10-10 ✅ | — the classic log-watching IPS that bans brute-forcing IPs; still the default answer on every Linux server. Used by sysadmins on millions of servers to stop brute force; the classic free guard no commercial tool needed to replace. (GPL-2.0) |

| TOOL | ★ STARS | CREATED | LAST PUSH | LICENSE / TIER |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Lynis | 16.5k | 2013 | 2026-09-16 | — agentless system auditing and hardening with CIS/PCI-DSS-aligned findings; runs anywhere in minutes. Used by system auditors running CIS-style hardening checks; the open-source alternative to commercial compliance scanners for Linux/Unix hosts. (GPL-3.0) |
| CrowdSec | 15.2k | 2020 | 2026-10-21 ✅ | — collaborative behavior-detection engine with a global IP-reputation network; the modern Fail2ban, 60x faster and IPv6-ready. Used by server administrators and hosting providers; the open-source, crowdsourced alternative to commercial WAF and bot-management services. |
| OpenVPN | 14.7k | 2012 | 2026-10-22 ✅ | — the industry-standard open-source VPN daemon for site-to-site and remote-access tunnels. Used by IT teams everywhere; the open-source alternative to commercial VPN gateways. (GPL-2.0 core, component exceptions) |
| OpenSnitch | 14.2k | 2017 | 2026-07-26 | — interactive application firewall (Little Snitch for Linux): allow/deny every outbound connection per process. Used by Linux power users and admins wanting per-application firewall control; the open equivalent of Little Snitch on macOS. (GPL-3.0) |
| OpenNHP | 13.9k | 2014 | 2026-10-22 ✅ | — go implementation of the Cloud Security Alliance's Network-infrastructure Hiding Protocol: conceals ports, IPs and domains behind a cryptographically signed knock gate — services stay invisible until the client proves trust. Used by zero-trust teams making infrastructure undiscoverable to mass and AI-driven scanning; the reference open implementation of CSA NHP. (Apache-2.0) |
| Vuls | 12.3k | 2016 | 2026-10-21 ✅ | — agentless vulnerability scanner for servers and containers, with CVE reporting across Linux and FreeBSD fleets. Used by server admins for agentless vulnerability scanning; the open-source alternative to Nessus for host patch audits. (GPL-3.0) |
| BunkerWeb | 11.1k | 2019 | 2026-10-21 ✅ | — next-gen open WAF built on nginx: HTTPS, bot mitigation and network protections on by default. Used by web admins wanting a next-gen open-source WAF in front of their sites; the self-hosted alternative to Cloudflare's managed WAF. (AGPL-3.0) |
| testssl.sh | 9.2k | 2014 | 2026-10-21 ✅ | — command-line TLS/SSL configuration auditor: protocols, ciphers, chains, vulnerabilities, grading — no agent required. Used by TLS auditors and pentesters everywhere; the free command-line alternative to Qualys SSL Labs for server-side TLS grading. (GPL-2.0) |
| ClamAV | 7.4k | 2012 | 2026-08-27 | — the open-source antivirus engine that powers mail gateways and file-screening pipelines everywhere. Used on countless mail gateways and Linux file screens; the AV engine many commercial mail filters embed. (GPL-2.0) |
| Fleet | 7k | 2020 | 2026-10-22 ✅ | — osquery fleet management: device visibility and policy enforcement at scale, open core with a free tier. Used by IT and security teams managing osquery fleets at scale; the open-source alternative to commercial device management and EDR consoles. (MIT, open core) |
| dev-sec hardening collection | 5.5k | 2015 | 2026-10-13 ✅ | — battle-tested Ansible roles for OS, SSH, nginx and MySQL baselines; hardening as code. Used by DevOps teams enforcing server baselines as code; the open-source alternative to commercial configuration-compliance agents. |
| OSSEC | 5.1k | 2013 | 2026-10-21 ✅ | — the original open-source HIDS: log analysis, file integrity and rootkit detection (Wazuh's ancestor). Used by SOC teams on a budget for host intrusion detection; the veteran open HIDS that predates commercial EDR. (GPL-2.0) |
| OPNsense | 4.8k | 2014 | 2026-10-21 ✅ | — open-source firewall/router distro with IDS, VPN and reporting — a pfSense successor built on HardenedBSD. Used by network administrators as a full open-source firewall/router; the business-ready free alternative to commercial UTM appliances. (BSD-2) |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| ssh-audit | 4.3k | 2017 | 2026-10-17 ✅ | — SSH server configuration auditor: algorithms, keys and best-practice flags in one run. Used by server hardening teams to audit SSH configurations and algorithms; the standard free SSH auditor. (GPL-3.0) |
| OpenSSH | 4.1k | 2014 | 2026-10-18 ✅ | — the world's default secure remote-access suite: encrypted shells, tunnels and key management. Used on virtually every Linux server on earth; the open standard for secure remote access that commercial SSH servers complement, not replace. (BSD-style) |
| Coraza | 3.9k | 2020 | 2026-10-21 ✅ | — ModSecurity-compatible WAF engine in Go; the actively developed successor for OWASP CRS deployments. Used by platform teams embedding a WAF engine inside Go services. |
| OWASP Core Rule Set | 3.3k | 2020 | 2026-10-22 ✅ | — the world's most-deployed WAF ruleset; battle-tested protection for web servers, tuned for ModSecurity and Coraza. Used by WAF administrators on nginx, Apache and Coraza; the free ruleset protecting more sites than most commercial WAF feeds. |
| OpenRASP | 3k | 2017 | 2025-10-02 ⏳ | — runtime application self-protection: instrument the app itself so attacks get blocked from the inside. Used by AppSec teams adding runtime self-protection to apps; the open-source alternative to commercial RASP vendors. |
| ComplianceAsCode content | 2.8k | 2014 | 2026-10-22 ✅ | — the open SCAP/Baseline rule corpus for RHEL, Ubuntu and friends; the content that powers OpenSCAP-style audits. Used by compliance and platform teams applying SCAP hardening profiles; the open-source ruleset commercial compliance products build on. |
| checksec.sh | 2.4k | 2014 | 2026-09-24 ✅ | — one-shot binary hardening audit: NX, canaries, PIE, RELRO and fortify flags in a single run. Used by exploit developers and binary auditors checking hardening mitigations; the standard free one-liner for this job. (BSD-3-Clause) |
| Neo23x0 auditd config | 2k | 2018 | 2026-05-04 | — Florian Roth's hardened auditd rule set: the Linux logging baseline used across incident-response teams. Used by blue teams hardening Linux audit collection; the widely-forked open auditd baseline behind many SOC deployments. (Apache-2.0) |
| open-appsec | 1.7k | 2022 | 2026-09-06 | — ML-driven prevention engine that stops OWASP Top 10 and zero-day web attacks without signatures. Used by security teams deploying machine-learning WAF protection; an open-source alternative to commercial ML-based WAF products. |
| SELinux | 1.6k | 2014 | 2026-10-16 ✅ | — mandatory access control for Linux: policy-based confinement that survives a compromised application. Used by hardened enterprise Linux deployments; the mandatory access control standard in RHEL-family distributions. (GPL-2.0) |
| shellfirm | 949 | 2021 | 2026-05-15 | — a pre-execution guard for your shell: challenges dangerous commands (rm -rf, kubectl delete) before they run. Used by engineers protecting themselves from dangerous commands; a lightweight open guardrail before your shell executes rm -rf. (Apache-2.0) |
| AIDE | 757 | 2019 | 2026-09-22 ✅ | — Advanced Intrusion Detection Environment: file-integrity monitoring that alerts the moment system files change. Used by hardening teams for file-integrity monitoring; the free open alternative to commercial FIM modules. (GPL-2.0) |
| stunnel | 397 | 2015 | 2026-09-17 | — universal TLS wrapper that adds encryption to any TCP service in minutes. Used by admins adding TLS to legacy services; the free universal TLS wrapper. (GPL-2.0) |
| unmask | 5 | 2026 | 2026-10-21 ✅ | — self-hosted privacy-first bot management gateway with verified-crawler bypass. Used by teams filtering bot traffic without third-party SaaS; the self-hosted bot-defense gateway. (Apache-2.0) |
| Netfilter/iptables | — | — | — | — the Linux kernel's native packet-filtering framework; the foundation every host firewall build starts from. Used by every Linux firewall admin; the kernel-level packet filter that commercial Linux firewalls wrap a UI around. (GPL-2.0) |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| **OpenBSD PF** | — | — | — | — the packet filter famous for correctness and readable rules; the syntax OpenBSD, pfSense and OPNsense share. Used by OpenBSD and firewall admins; the famously audited packet filter behind many security appliances. (ISC) |
| **Qubes OS** | — | — | — | — the security-by-compartmentalization desktop OS; " reasonably secure" by architecture, not by antivirus. Used by journalists, researchers and high-risk users; the compartmentalized security desktop with no commercial counterpart. (GPL-2.0) |
| **SpamAssassin** | — | — | — | — the veteran open-source spam filter; bayesian scoring and rule engine at the mail gateway. Used by mail administrators on countless gateways; the veteran open-source anti-spam engine many commercial filters license. (Apache-2.0) |
| **Tor** | — | — | — | — the anonymity network: routed egress through thousands of volunteer relays; the standard for privacy-preserving research access. Used by privacy-focused researchers, journalists and investigators; the free anonymity network with no commercial equivalent. (BSD-3-Clause) |